38번

Mathematics can be considered a universal language, but most of it is explicitly taught. However, it is suggested that some aspects of mathematical knowledge could be innate and present from birth: for example, the ability to discern between different quantities (i.e. large versus small), while understanding of the relationships and associations between numbers are predominantly learnt. Although mathematics can be considered a universal language, there are distinct language and cultural differences in how counting systems are used. For example, in English, words like 'eleven' and 'twelve' do not directly reflect the values that they stand for, 10+1 and 10+2. However, in Chinese, the number system is very logical, with words that directly reflect the values that are used. For example, the number 20 in Chinese, ershi, literally translates as 'two-ten'. But it is not only the linguistic representation of numbers that differs; the counting systems used also differ. Although the decimal system predominates today, other counting systems have been developed over time, for example, the Mayan numeral system used a base 20 system.